

The *Contact page* has a form that routes any message from the user directly to my inbox. This allows users to send requests instantly while keeping my email address private.

A backend is the server part of the website which is needed to handle databases and any relevant APIs. On my portfolio, it is needed to process the server side logic involved in sending the message to my email.

This was done by first configuring the form's Send button to send the user's message to the function defined in *send.js* file inside the project's *api* folder. Since I am using a Gmail account, I used SMTP for sending the email and *Nodemailer* as a project dependency in the project to handle the email delivery.

I added the relevant variables — SMTP_HOST, SMTP_PORT, SMTP_USER, SMTP_PASS, and TO_EMAIL — to an *.env.local* file which was added to *.gitignore* to prevent the sensitive credentials from being pushed to the GitHub repository. All these variables were then added to Vercel's production environment variables to ensure the form worked when the website was deployed.

The data flow is: user fills in the form → the *React* frontend sends the form data to */api/send* → the server-side function processes the request → *Nodemailer* uses the SMTP configuration to send the message → the message arrives in my Gmail inbox. The user then receives a success or error message depending on whether the request was successful.

Working feature:

The screenshot shows a contact form on a portfolio website for Amna Ibrar. The website has a dark green header with the name 'Amna Ibrar' and 'AI & Software Projects' on the left, and navigation links 'Home', 'Work', 'About', and 'Contact' on the right. The main content area is split into two columns. The left column is dark grey and contains a circular profile picture, the text 'GET IN TOUCH', 'Let's connect.', a paragraph about projects and internships, and links to LinkedIn, a 30-minute chat, and GitHub. The right column is light pink and contains the heading 'Send an inquiry', a note about response time, and input fields for Name (filled with 'tony'), Email (filled with 'neonbot331@gmail.com'), and a text area (filled with 'hi I want to discuss the Bridge app you've showcased on the work page.'). A 'Send message' button is at the bottom of the right column. The footer is dark green with 'Amna Ibrar' on the left and '© 2026 — AI & software projects, designed with intent.' on the right.

Name

Your full name

Email

you@example.com

Tell me more

What are you building?

Send message

© 2026 — AI & software projects, designed with intent.

Message sent — thank you! ✕

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Portfolio inquiry from tony

inbox ✕

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mano36713@gmail.com

to me ▾

Name: tony

Email: neonbot331@gmail.com

Message:

hi! i want to discuss the Bridge app you've showcased on the work page.

↩️ Reply

➡️ Forward

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